

Care about and care for

Learner workbook

Say what matters to you and who you look after.

Understand the distinction

Care about commonly means consider important: I care about the environment. Care for can mean look after: She cares for her father. Take care of also means look after or deal with.

Care for can mean like or want in some contexts: I do not care for this music; Would you care for some tea? These uses are often more formal. I do not care can sound dismissive, so choose a clearer phrase when you simply have no preference.

Compare the patterns

IMPORTANCE

I care about the result.

The result matters to me.

LOOK AFTER

I care for my grandmother.

I help look after her.

NO PREFERENCE

Either time works for me.

A considerate alternative to I do not care.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. Choose the phrase that expresses concern for an issue: We care ____ clean water.

- A. about
- B. of
- C. to

2. He cares for his elderly neighbor by cooking meals and helping with daily tasks. What does cares for mean here?

- A. Look after.
- B. Ask the neighbor for advice.
- C. Have no preference about.

3. Choose an alternative to I do not care when either restaurant is fine.

- A. Either restaurant is fine with me.
- B. Neither restaurant is acceptable.
- C. I strongly prefer the first restaurant.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. Punctuality matters to you, but you accept either cafe. Which pair communicates both points?

- A. I care about arriving on time. Neither cafe is acceptable.
- B. I care about arriving on time. Either cafe works for me.
- C. I do not care about arriving on time. Either cafe works for me.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. A. about

This expresses importance or concern.

2. A. Look after.

The context describes providing care.

3. A. Either restaurant is fine with me.

This states a preference without sounding dismissive.

4. B. I care about arriving on time. Either cafe works for me.

Care about expresses the concern; either cafe accepts both options.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-33.html